



Fall 2019 Research Summit

Using the RSA 911 Dataset to inform our understanding of higher education for students with intellectual disability

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NATIONAL COORDINATING CENTER



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Today's presentations

Introduction:RSA-911 Data

Frank Smith

Effect of College for People with Intellectual Disabilities on Employment, Income, and SSI.

Tom Sannicandro

Postsecondary Education and Individuals with Intellectual Disabilities: Evidence and Policy Implications.

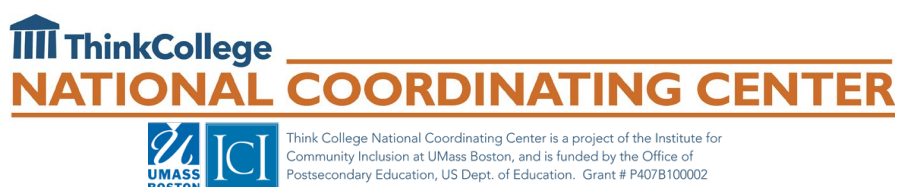
Stormy Miller Sabia and Mark Tucker





Introduction: Rehabilitation Services Administration (RSA)-911 Data

Frank Smith
Think College



What is the RSA-911?

- A case service record file that contains information on people who receive services state vocational rehabilitation (VR) program
- Typically includes 800,000+ records
- Statutorily defined in "The Rehab Act" as amended by WIOA
- State VR agencies are responsible for maintaining their own records in and uploading them to RSA data systems quarterly



Uses of RSA-911 Data

- Serve a number of statutorily defined purposes mainly around reporting on the effectiveness of VR programs
- Researchers use RSA-911 to understand what is happening in the system, in a given state, for specific subpopulations of VR service recipients, and for many other reasons
- Practitioners, like TA providers, use RSA-911 data to understand how to improve services and outcomes for people with disabilities



Who is included in the RSA-911?

Consumer Type	Definition	Included in calculations for performance indicators?	Collect and report outcome data?
Participant	Have an approved individualized plan for employment (IPE) and has begun receiving VR services	Yes	Yes
Reportable individual	Individuals who have applied for VR services, but have not yet met the definition of "participant" Students with disabilities receiving pre-employment transition services prior to applying and being determined eligible for VR services and having an approved IPE.	No	No



Data elements in the RSA-911*

- Personal and demographic information about VR consumers
- Baseline information on employment, education, and income at time of application
- Services received by consumers during participation in VR program
- Information on employment, education, and income at time of exit from program



*If you add the RSA-911 care record file will contain 407 individual data elements. Our list above is not exhaustive.



Higher education data elements in the 911

- VR agencies can purchase “higher education services” for VR consumers.
 - Higher education services are synonymous with enrollment.
- Services can be graduate level, at a four- or two-year IHE, or at a technical college.
- Agencies report:
 - When VR officially purchases higher ed. services, AKA pays for consumer to enroll
 - Who VR purchased the services from (CRP or otherwise*)
 - Quarterly expenditures on the services
 - If and when a credential is earned

Example Entry from RSA-911 Data Dictionary

Element: Four-Year College or University Training, Service Provided through VR Agency Purchase

Definition and Instructions: Full-time or part-time academic training leading to a baccalaureate degree, a certificate, or other recognized less than postgraduate educational credential. Such training may be provided by a four-year college or university or technical college. Report at the time the service is provided.



*Some agencies pay an IHE directly.



Notable recent changes to the RSA-911

- Addition of collection on reportable individuals
- Collects data on open services records, not just closed service records
- Files available on a quarterly basis, used to be annual
- Changes to how and when employment outcomes are reported
- Added "Worked Based Learning Experience" to the list of purchased services that can be reported



Accessing the RSA-911

- Contact RSA at RSAData@ed.gov and tell them you want a copy of the RSA-911 data file.
- Will require you to sign a formal data use agreement
- May be delivered by an ASCII file. This means you or a colleague will need to write code using the case record layout information in the RSA-911 data dictionary to read the data into SPSS, Stata, Excel, or another analytical tool.



Effect of Postsecondary Education on
Employment and Income for Individuals with
Intellectual Disabilities

Think College
Fall 2019 Research Summit

Tom Sannicandro, JD, PhD
October 10, 2019



Overview of Presentation

Introduction & Background	Approach Why? Overarching Aims
Research Method	Data Sources Analyses
Findings	
Discussion & Conclusion	Strengths and Limitations Policy implications Future research



Why This Research?

- 3 -6 million people with intellectual disabilities
- How we provide opportunity for them
- How we assure they have the highest quality of life
- Providing the same opportunities as everyone else
- Students with intellectual disabilities included in K-12
- Not included in higher education
 - must earn the right
 - not an entitlement
- Benefit to the individual and the society for students with intellectual disabilities in higher education
- Does postsecondary education make a difference?



Background and Literature Review

1. Historical Context
2. Employment Disparities
 - Employment rate ID 23%
 - Disabilities 30%
 - Non-disabled 79%
3. The Vocational Rehabilitation Program
4. Literature Review
 - Postsecondary Education and Employment



Research Aims

- **Aim 1:** Examine the effect of postsecondary education on employment for individuals with intellectual disabilities.
- **Aim 2:** Determine if the students with intellectual disabilities, who benefit from attending postsecondary education, are different from students with intellectual disabilities who do not.



Research Aims

- **Aim 4:** Examine the relationship between postsecondary education for individuals with intellectual disabilities, employment outcomes and characteristics of state VR agencies.
- **Aim 5:** Describe the change from 2008 to 2013 in availability of postsecondary educational experiences for individuals with intellectual disabilities and their employment outcomes and change in percent employment for individuals with intellectual disabilities.



Data Sources

Individual Data

- a) Rehabilitation Services Administration's (RSA) 911 dataset
- b) Students with Intellectual Disabilities within the transition age from 16-30
- c) FY 2008 through FY 2013 RSA-911
 - N=~3.6 million
 - ID: N=~300,000
 - 16-30 with ID: N=~180,000
 - Propensity score group= 11,280

d)



Data Sources

State Policy Data

- a) VR system
- b) Employment First
- c) State Developmental Disability Agency spending per median income

State Economic Data

- a) State employment rates for individuals with disabilities
- b) Poverty level



Dependent Variables

- Employed
- Weekly earnings
- Amount of SSI benefit per month
- Occupation at closure
 - Employment in a job not usually held by individual with an intellectual disability
 - Management
 - Community and social service occupations



Independent Variables

- Postsecondary education
- Funds expended by state VR agency/state per median income



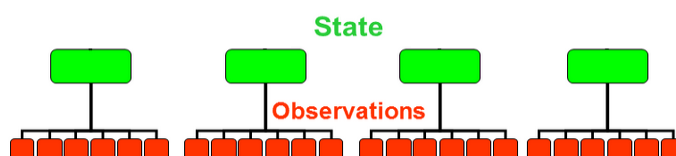
Individual Covariates

- Gender
- Race
- Training provided
- Cost of purchased services
- Medicaid recipient at application



Method

- **Research Design:** Quantitative analysis of secondary data
- Comparison Group
- **Analyses:** Hierarchical Linear (Logistic) Modeling (HLM)



Comparison Group

Propensity Score

1. Significant disability
2. Individual received special education services in secondary education
3. Whether the individual was employed at application
4. Level of education at application



Propensity Score

Covariates	Pre-Propensity Score Matching			Post-Propensity Score Matching		
	ID no PSE	ID & PSE	Test statistics	ID no PSE	ID & PSE	Test statistics
	(N=190,175)	(N=9,266)		(N=5,640)	(N=5,640)	
	<i>n</i> (%)	<i>n</i> (%)	χ^2	<i>n</i> (%)	<i>n</i> (%)	χ^2
Significant disability	181,520 (96.8%)	8,798 (95.8%)	29 ***	5,429 (96.3%)	5,429 (96.3%)	0
Special education ¹	155,307 (81.7%)	6,433 (69.5%)	863 ***	4,451 (78.9%)	4,451 (78.9%)	0
Employed at application	16,471 (8.7%)	1,541 (16.6%)	199,426 ***	858 (15.2%)	858 (15.2%)	0
	<i>Mean (SD)</i>	<i>Mean (SD)</i>	<i>t</i>	<i>Mean (SD)</i>	<i>Mean (SD)</i>	<i>t</i>
Education ² at application	2.7 (0.8)	3.7 (3.7)	-110 ***	2.7 (0.9)	2.7 (0.9)	0

* $p < 0.05$; ** $p < 0.01$; *** $p < 0.001$;

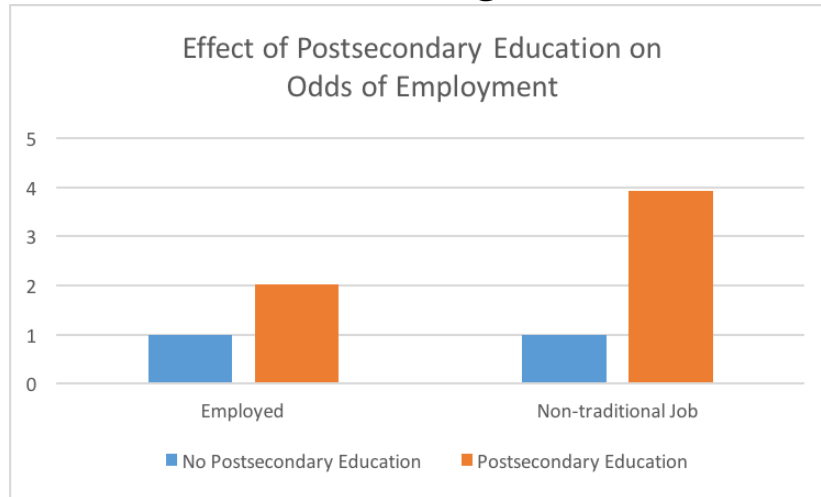
Note. SD = standard deviation. ID = intellectual disability. PSE = postsecondary education.

¹ Received special education services in secondary school.

² Education is measured as a 9 level ordered categorical variable, where "8" is the highest and "0" is the lowest.

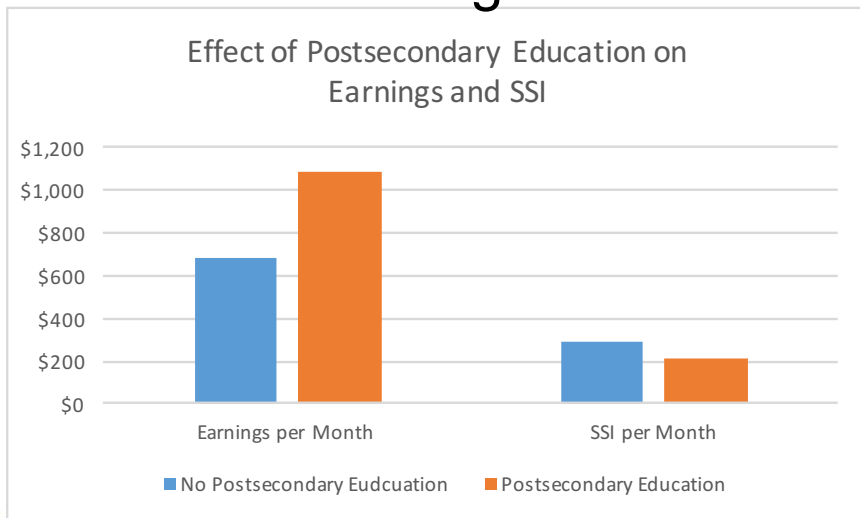


Findings



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Findings

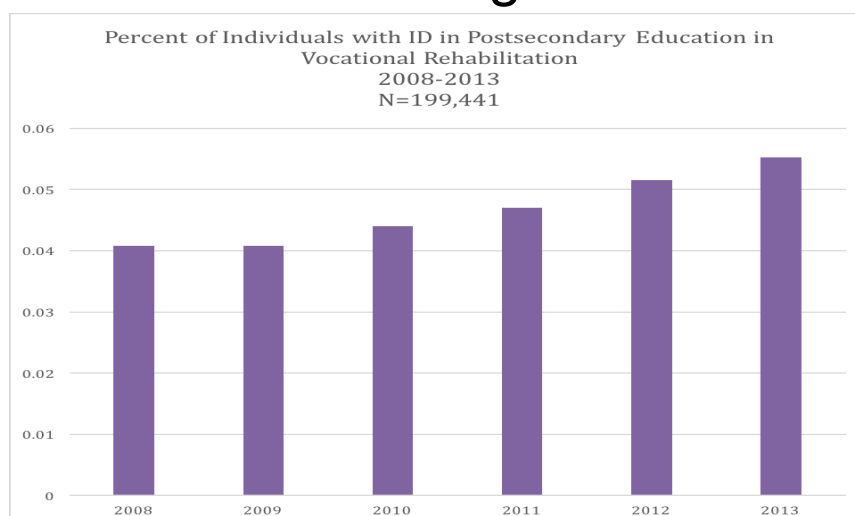


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Findings

	Employed OR	Non- traditional job ¹ OR	Earnings per week Coef.	SSI per month Coef.
PSE (2011-2013) compared to (2008-2010)	2.02 *** 0.99	3.93 *** 0.77 *	87.34 *** 12.50 **	-73.06 *** 7.41
Gender				
Male vs. Female	1.17 ***	0.37 ***	48.13 ***	2.36
Race ²				
White	1.31 ***	1.27	-10.52 * ^a	-10.47
American Indian	1.06	2.42	-23.41	-28.07
Asian	1.53 *	1.16	-61.65 ***	-8.82
Native Hawaiian or Pacific Islander	0.81	1.83	-6.17	17.73
Hispanic	1.15	1.24	14.07	-39.49 ***
Training	1.72 ***	0.52 ***	8.69 *	-7.25
Cost of Services ³				
\$321	1.80 ***	0.78	-1.76	-4.23
\$1,397	3.05 ***	1.26	-17.19 *	16.26 *
\$3,911	7.29 ***	1.38	-17.82 *	16.62 *
\$9,225	14.94 ***	1.80 *	-30.32 ***	44.66 ***
Medicaid ⁴	1.41 ***	1.99 ***	43.25 ***	-178.55 ***
Employment Rate ⁵	1.03 ***	0.99	1.19 *	1.20
DDinVR ⁶	1.02 ***	1.01	0.17	-2.75 *

Findings



Strengths

- Nationally representative dataset
- Supplemented with variables from other sources
 - Unemployment rates, poverty rates, educational levels
- Creating a comparison group



Limitations

- Selection bias
- Measures
 - Identification of postsecondary education
 - Intellectual disability by the in-take worker
- Generalization
 - Examining individuals within the VR system
 - Selection bias
- Duplicate information from year to year



Implications for Future research

- Dose effect
- Other populations
- Qualitative studies



Implications

- Policy
 - Change special education law
 - Expanded role of college and university system
 - Vocational rehabilitation services
 - State policies
 - Reallocation of resources
 - More individuals into higher education



Discussion



POSTSECONDARY EDUCATION SUPPORT AND EARNING OUTCOMES THROUGH PARTICIPATION IN VOCATIONAL REHABILITATION SERVICES

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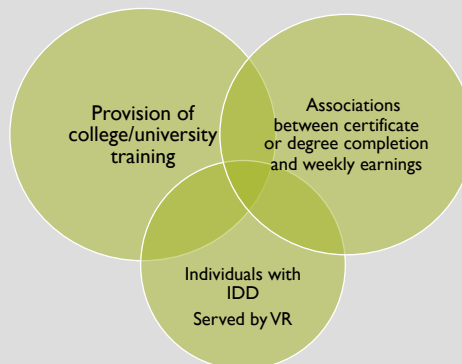
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INTRODUCTION

- Recognition of the need for young adults to earn postsecondary degrees and credentials for the U.S. to compete in a global marketplace (College and Career Readiness and Success Center, 2013)
- Disparities in labor force participation, employment rates, earnings
- Limited opportunity for career advancement among individuals with disabilities who are employed (Siperstein, Parker, & Drascher, 2013).
- 34.7% of people with disabilities employed in 2019 (Kessler Foundation, 2019)
- Greater disparity among youth with intellectual disability (ID) in employment and earning outcomes
- Less likely to have postsecondary education and employment goals in transition plans (Grigal, Hart, & Migliore, 2011; Grigal, Migliore, & Hart, 2014).

PURPOSE OF THE STUDY



CALIFORNIA LANDSCAPE

Large VR agency – 1,800 staff (California Department of Rehabilitation, n.d.)

Large system of higher education -\$29.2 billion allocated from the CA budget in 2015-2016 (State of California, 2016)

97,673 individuals served FFY 2014 (36,556 new applicants)

History of implementing legislation and policies in support of PSE and employment



METHODS

- Rehabilitation Services Administration records (RSA-911) were utilized
- RSA-911 cases closed during federal fiscal years 2006-2016
- Outcome variables of *weekly earnings at the time of case closure* and the *provision of postsecondary education support* by VR
- Independent variables of primary disability, educational attainment, and highest level of educational attainment at application and case closure
- Specifically looking at service provision to individuals with IDD
- Delimited the data to California for RQ #1 through #3 and California compared to all other states with VR agencies for RQ #4

RESEARCH QUESTIONS ?

- RQ1: Was there a significant difference in mean weekly earnings at case closure between individuals with IDD in California who advanced to postsecondary certificate or degree completion while their rehabilitation case was open and individuals with IDD who did not advance to postsecondary certificate or degree completion?
- RQ2: Were there any significant differences in mean weekly earnings at case closure between individuals with four different types of IDD in California (cerebral palsy, autism, epilepsy, or intellectual disability)?
- RQ3: When examining provision of postsecondary education support by the California VR agency between federal fiscal years 2006 and 2016, were there any significant year-to-year differences among the proportions of cases provided with college that were individuals with IDD?
- RQ4: For cases closed during federal fiscal year 2014 was there a significant difference between the proportions of individuals with IDD who were provided with college when comparing California to all other state VR agencies combined?

RESULTS

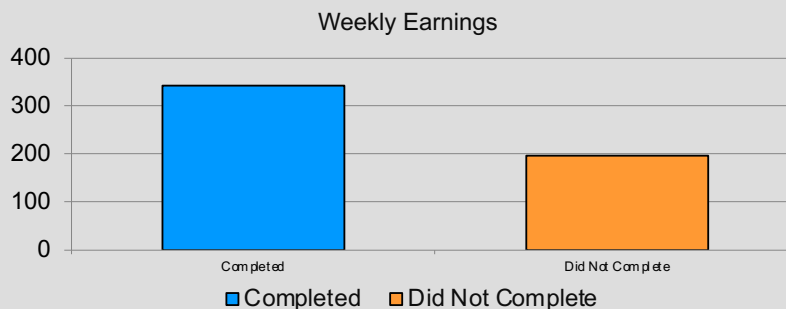


FIGURE 1: Weekly Earnings at Case Closure in California (postsecondary education completion vs. those who did not complete)

RESULTS

Proportion of Individuals Provided with College that had IDD

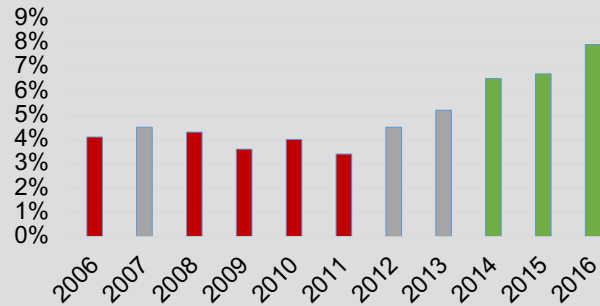


FIGURE 2: Proportions of Individuals Provided with College Support in California

RESULTS

Nationwide Proportion of Individuals Provided with College that had IDD, FFY 2014

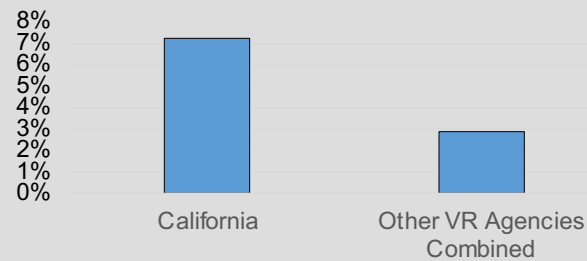


FIGURE 3: Nationwide Proportion of Individuals Provided with College Support Compared to California

IMPLICATIONS FOR PRACTICE

- Postsecondary education as a service outlined in the Individualized Plan for Employment (IPE)
- Local education partnership program development and agreements (K-12, VR, community colleges and four-year colleges and universities, regional center systems [CA])
- Expansion of policy initiatives that support ID access to postsecondary education as a means to increasing employment opportunities
- Blending funding and pooling resources
- Individual and family member advocacy for resources and support to pursue postsecondary education

FUTURE RESEARCH

- Access to other organization involvement in the provision of postsecondary education support
- Identification of wages of individuals with IDD and industry specific areas
- Analysis of VR cases by zip code would allow for greater analysis of service provision
- Examination of transition age youth (TAY) to determine case duration, postsecondary provision and employment outcomes

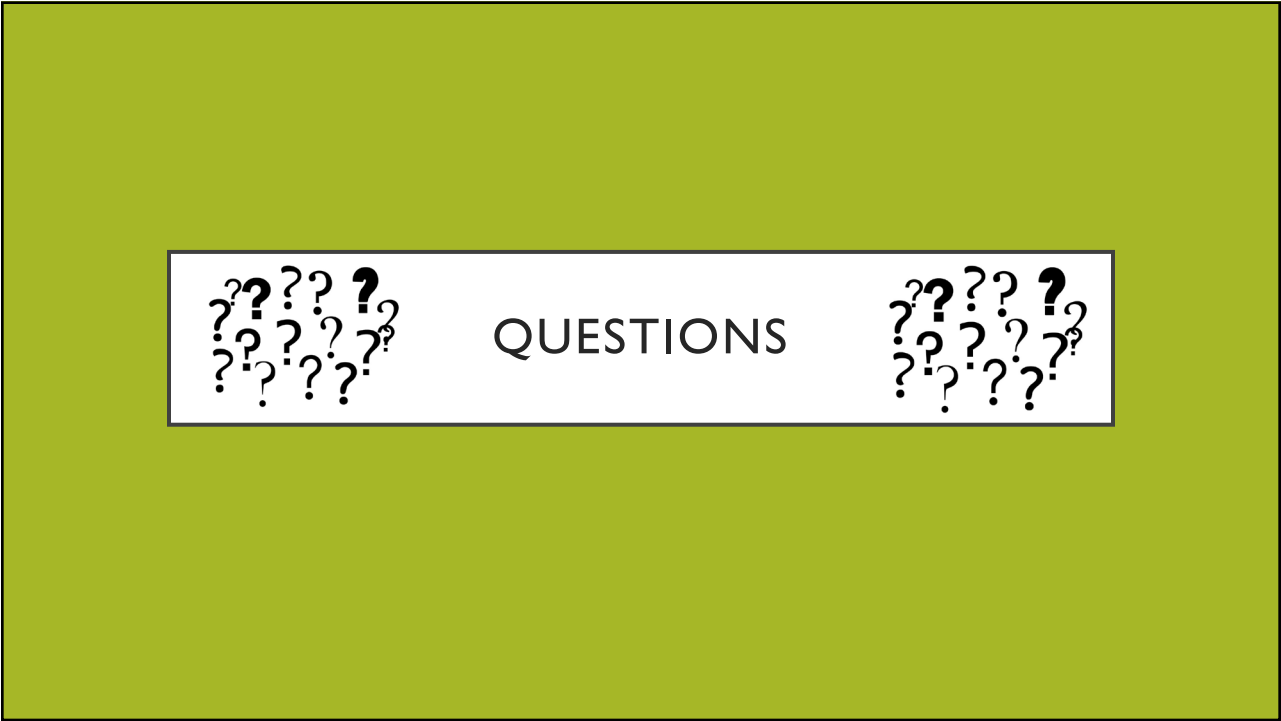


LIMITATIONS & CONCLUSIONS

- Addressing research questions beyond the scope of the dataset
- The possibility of incorrect input of information
- Outcomes cannot be generalized to those who did not receive VR services
- Information on the current landscape and potential shifts in service delivery
- Raise awareness on options stemming from policy, practice, and research
- Postsecondary education as a path to greater employment outcomes for individuals with IDD as part of the overall higher education initiative

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- Connect with other researchers and explore possible collaborations
 - Share tools and resources

Next meeting: Wednesday November 13th 2019, 12:30-1:30pm Pacific (3:30-4:30pm Eastern)

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